Market research

Using Data to Drive Business Performance

Research and proposal review · October 2026

How the market research was done

What we reviewed	Federal degree statistics (NCES and IPEDS, through Data USA), peer-reviewed studies of business and IS curricula, AACSB accreditation data, U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics projections, the World Economic Forum's employer survey, and an analysis of 855 U.S. data analyst job postings. Our own syllabus research, below, adds the textbook and AI-policy findings.
How	We retained published figures with their source years, separated degree counts from course and program evidence, and used two combinations as illustrative reach proxies. Each proxy is shown with its assumptions and requires publisher validation.
What we looked for	How many students take a course like this each year, which programs require it, what employers ask for, and whether any textbook already owns the market.

Finding 1: a large, required course

About 375,400 degrees a year	**Business bachelor's degrees awarded in the U.S.** About one in five of all bachelor's degrees (2021-22).Source: NCES [1]
88% of business schools	**Require an information systems course of every business student** In a study of 61 business schools, 89% of them AACSB-accredited, 85% required one IS course in the core and 3% required two.Source: Fustos et al. [2]
12,092 degrees in 2024	**Management information systems degrees awarded** Up 3.4% from 2023.Source: Data USA [3]
87.3% of IS programs	**Offer a data and information management course** 344 of 394 U.S. undergraduate IS programs.Source: Hwang, Ma and Wang [4]

285 of 535 **AACSB schools**	**U.S. AACSB-accredited schools with an information systems program** A further 109 offer an undergraduate business analytics program.Source: Zheng et al. [5]
82% **of IS master's programs**	**Require a data management course** 61 of 74 programs at AACSB schools: a graduate audience for the same material.Source: Yang [6]
81,835 **degrees in 2024**	**Accounting degrees awarded, an adjacent audience** Accounting information systems courses cover much of the same ground.Source: Data USA [7]
1,098 **schools**	**AACSB-accredited business schools worldwide** In 71 countries, as of September 2026.Source: AACSB [8]

Two routes, one book

A commonality we found: **most business schools require an information systems course of every business student, and most MIS programs require a database course.** The proposed routes address these two settings; fit must be reviewed against each course's outcomes and available teaching time. In round numbers:

About 330,000 **Illustrative reach proxy**	**Business students who reach a required IS course** About 375,400 business bachelor's degrees × the 88% of business schools that require the course.Source: Our estimate from [1], [2]
About 10,600 **Illustrative reach proxy**	**MIS students in programs with a database course** 12,092 MIS awards across all levels × the 87.3% of IS programs that offer the course.Source: Our estimate from [3], [4]

Planning assumptions: these reach proxies multiply degree counts by historical shares of institutions or programs. They are not enrollment-weighted course-seat estimates. The MIS and accounting totals cover all award levels, not bachelor's degrees alone. The routes overlap and must not be added together. Publisher enrollment and adoption data are needed to estimate addressable annual seats.

Finding 2: a varied textbook landscape

60 **titles**	**Textbooks named in the syllabi we reviewed** No title appeared at more than three institutions in the earlier 60-title catalogue. Instructor-made materials also appear. This indicates variety within the reviewed collection, rather than national market share.Source: Syllabus research, below
2021 **last revision**	**Cengage's applied business-database title** Concepts of Database Management, 10th edition, is built on Access 2019 and SQL Server 2019. It has served the course well, and the tools and topics have moved on since.Source: Cengage [13]

Student fees and adoption opportunity

Existing product / format	Listed U.S. price	Access or format
Database Systems 15e eBook	US$71.99	Access through January 22, 2027
Database Systems 15e eBook	US$98.99	Access through July 21, 2027
Database Systems 15e paperback	US$272.95	Print purchase
MindTap for Database Systems 15e	From US$149.00	Digital courseware; product / term selection applies

Segment	Likely need	Validation focus	Adoption opportunity
Primary Applied business database / MIS data management	Relational thinking, SQL, design, implementation, and business interpretation in one coherent learning path.	Course outcomes, annual sections and enrollments, required engine, incumbent materials, and switching criteria.	Full courseware adoption with readings, guided practice, independent labs, assessment, and instructor resources.
Business analytics foundations	Data preparation, trustworthy SQL measures, and reporting.	Required design depth, analytical prerequisites, and reporting platform.	A selected chapter / lab route that supplies the database foundation for analytics.
Business core / accounting information systems	Data meaning, information systems, controls, reporting, and a bounded project.	Which modules fit the existing course and how much SQL / design is expected.	Modular adoption or a companion pathway, subject to course fit.

Illustrative adoption scenario	Annual sections per institution	Students per section	Annual student seats	Validation focus
10 institutions	2	30	600	Recruit a small set of suitable courses; establish required tools and sample-unit fit.

Illustrative adoption scenario	Annual sections per institution	Students per section	Annual student seats	Validation focus
25 institutions	2	30	1,500	Confirm repeat adoption, instructor support needs, and section-level enrollments.
50 institutions	2	30	3,000	Validate capacity, delivery costs, distribution, and broader portfolio fit.

Student prices were retrieved October 25, 2026 and vary by format, access period and institutional arrangement. Adoption scenarios are arithmetic examples, not forecasts. A price for this proposed edition has not been set.

Main conclusion The evidence supports exploring two defined course routes: the required business-core data / IS course and the applied MIS database course. Validate their outcomes, tools, annual sections, student seats and switching criteria separately.

References

Market, employment and curriculum references

References

• National Center for Education Statistics. (2023). Digest of Education Statistics, Table 318.20: Degrees conferred by field of study, 2021-22. Link

• Fustos, J., et al. (2017). Do students get enough information systems education in the business core? Study of 61 business schools. Link

• Data USA. (2026). Management information systems and services (IPEDS completions, 2024). Link

• Hwang, D., Ma, Z., & Wang, M. (2015). The information systems core: A study from the perspective of IS core curricula in the U.S. Information Systems Education Journal, 13(6), 27-34. Link

• Zheng, Y., Hameed, T., Lavoie, R., & Sendall, P. (2021). An overview of current business analytics programs across US AACSB schools. Issues in Information Systems, 22(2), 306-317. Link

• Yang, S. C. (2023). The master's program in information systems: A survey of core curricula in AACSB-accredited business schools in the United States. Journal of Information Systems Education, 34(4), 430-440. Link

• Data USA. (2026). Accounting (IPEDS completions, 2024). Link

• AACSB International. (2026, September). Accreditation announcement, September 2026. Link

• 365 Data Science. (2026). The data analyst job market in 2026: Research on 1,000 job postings. Link

• U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics. (2026). Occupational Outlook Handbook: Data scientists. Link

• U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics. (2026). Occupational Outlook Handbook: Database administrators and architects. Link

• World Economic Forum. (2025). The Future of Jobs Report 2025. Link

• Cengage. Concepts of Database Management, 10th edition (2021). Link

Manuscript, textbook, platform and original-cover references

[S1]

Collected syllabus archive and manifest ↗

63 documents; 31 institutions; archived October 1, 2026. Mixed course levels and dates.

[S2]

Database-platform evidence model and report ↗

October 17, 2026 audit. Role-coded platform evidence, 54 selected course families; counts recalculated for this package.

[S3]

Curriculum audit ↗

October 1, 2026 document-level topic summaries and original-source references; used as a discovery aid and checked against archived course text.

[S4]

Textbook adoption and contents audit ↗

October 10, 2026 report: 60 named books/course texts. Historical school-level mentions, not market shares. Broader contents catalogue retained as prior research.

[S5]

Stabilized 14-chapter proposal ↗

Earlier synthesis, stored in the outline-comparison folder. This package proposes a refinement; it does not replace the manuscript outline.

[S6]

Current book repository ↗

Read-only inspection of main, commit 92d7a6ea04b96b67ef983aa22d054ab0bb9ad046; current chapter activation metadata checked.

[S7]

Inactive book-2027 candidate ↗

16-chapter migration candidate with separate core/extension routes. Its README explicitly states that it is inactive and is not published by the reader.

[S8]

Dima Publishing design and book description ↗

Publisher design reference and earlier public description. Cover for this revision comes from the current book website instead; see C1.

[S9]

Brightlab evaluation design document ↗

Prototype description, not validation of fairness, reliability, costs or deployability. Contradictory partial-credit claims require resolution.

[P1]

Cengage: Database Systems, 14th edition ↗

Coronel and Morris. Uploaded copy supplies the historical chapter sequence; official product page documents interactive MySQL labs and other MindTap resources.

[P2]

Cengage: Database Systems, 15th edition ↗

Coronel and Morris. Official current listing checked October 25, 2026; detailed sequence is retained from the earlier contents audit. Recent edition moves SQL ahead of the formal design sequence.

[P3]

Cengage: Concepts of Database Management, 10th edition ↗

Friedrichsen, Ruffolo, Monk, Starks, Pratt and Last. Official publisher search results provide the nine-module outline and Access practice description.

[P4]

Pearson: Database Concepts, 10th edition ↗

Kroenke, Auer, Vandenberg and Yoder. Current publisher educator page; the uploaded PDF is the older ninth edition, not the tenth.

[P5]

Pearson: Modern Database Management, 14th edition ↗

Hoffer, Topi, Venkataraman and Bala. Official contents and description checked October 25, 2026; explicitly covers analytics, cloud and AI.

[L1]

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics: Data Scientists ↗

Current Occupational Outlook Handbook read October 25, 2026. Projects 35% employment growth, 2025-2035; all occupations 3%.

[L2]

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics: Database Administrators and Architects ↗

Current Occupational Outlook Handbook read October 25, 2026. Architects 9%; administrators 0%; combined 4%, 2025-2035. Rounded percentages.

[L3]

World Economic Forum: Future of Jobs Report 2025 ↗

Employer expectations for 2025-2030: analytical thinking essential to about seven in ten responding companies; AI and big data lead skills expected to grow. Global employer survey, not U.S. hiring requirements.

[T1]

PGlite: What is PGlite? ↗

Official documentation: embedded PostgreSQL compiled to WebAssembly; runs in the browser, with optional local persistence. It is not itself a hosted cloud database.

[T2]

Supabase: Database overview ↗

Official documentation: each project provides a PostgreSQL database. Hosted operations, accounts, permissions and product limits require a separate teaching plan.

[T3]

Microsoft: Get Power BI Desktop ↗

Current installation documentation, checked October 25, 2026. Windows desktop authoring creates an access requirement for Mac users.

[M1]

NCES: Undergraduate Degree Fields ↗

2021-22: 375,400 business bachelor’s degrees, 19% of bachelor’s awards. Broad audience context; degree completions are not database-course enrollments.

[M2]

Cengage: Database Systems, 15th edition, U.S. product listing ↗

Pricing retrieved October 25, 2026: eBook US$71.99 through January 22, 2027 or US$98.99 through July 21, 2027; paperback US$272.95; MindTap advertised from US$149.00. Prices and access dates can change.

[C1]

Original cover on the current book website ↗

Existing animated cover URL verified in the current repository’s HomePage component. Used unchanged, with a still-image fallback for reduced motion.